

AJ BARNETT

STAFF / LEAD SOFTWARE ENGINEER | FRONTEND PLATFORM & FULL-STACK ENGINEERING

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff-level software engineer and technical lead with 15+ years of experience building frontend platforms, full-stack applications, and enterprise design systems. Led the architecture and adoption of a 170+ asset React and TypeScript platform, increasing enterprise adoption from 38% to 92% and saving an estimated 111 engineering hours per developer annually. Hands-on across React, TypeScript, Node.js, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, authentication, CI/CD, accessibility, and legacy modernization. Known for mentoring engineers, establishing scalable standards, and aligning technical decisions with measurable business outcomes.

EXPERIENCE

CDW CORPORATION

Senior Software Engineer I | Technical Lead

Remote

2022–2026

- Served as Technical Lead for Legato, CDW's enterprise design system, guiding platform architecture, reusable component development, accessibility, developer experience, governance, and adoption.
- Increased enterprise adoption from 38% to 92% across Digital Customer teams (142% growth), establishing Legato as the standard frontend platform.
- Enabled 70.4% of new enterprise feature releases (19 of 27 major initiatives) to ship on Legato instead of legacy frameworks.
- Co-led the architecture and long-term evolution of more than 170 reusable UI assets across React, TypeScript, Stencil Web Components, and HTML/JavaScript.
- Reduced developer effort by an estimated 111 hours annually per engineer (4.6 hours per sprint) through reusable components, standardized patterns, and Storybook documentation.
- Led and mentored five software engineers through architectural guidance, code reviews, technical coaching, interviews, and collaborative problem-solving.
- Architected a scalable design-token system and established Storybook as the source of truth for implementation guidance, engineering standards, and accessible component usage.
- Embedded WCAG 2.1 AA and Section 508 requirements into reusable platform components, enabling consistent accessibility across enterprise applications.
- Partnered with Engineering Leadership, Product, UX, and QA to define governance, architecture standards, and long-term frontend platform strategy.
- Modernized legacy .NET microsites by incrementally bootstrapping React into production applications, enabling phased migration without disrupting users.
- Earned Sprint MVP recognition more than 10 times and Program Increment MVP recognition for technical leadership and delivery.

EQUITY TRUST COMPANY (MIDLAND TRUST)

Software Engineer

Fort Myers, FL

2020–2022

- Designed and delivered enterprise financial software supporting Self-Directed IRAs, 1031 Exchanges, retirement accounts, and payment workflows while modernizing frontend architecture and building scalable full-stack applications.
- Architected applications using React, Node.js, PostgreSQL, REST APIs, Redux, and Sequelize, connecting interfaces, backend services, authentication, databases, and business workflows.
- Built React-based custom portals that moved clients from Salesforce Community/Sites to Microsoft Entra-authenticated experiences, reducing reliance on paid Salesforce user licenses.
- Developed client, advisor, and payment portals with dashboards, calculators, automation, account-management tools, and third-party access workflows.
- Implemented Microsoft Entra ID authentication and custom role-based authorization to meet enterprise security requirements.
- Built cross-platform web, iOS, and Android applications using React and Ionic.
- Optimized performance, accessibility, SEO, and engineering quality, consistently achieving near-perfect Google Lighthouse scores.
- Managed deployments, Git workflows, release pipelines, and production support across multiple enterprise applications.

EXPERIENCE, CONTINUED

PRIORITY MARKETING

Fort Myers, FL

Full-Stack Software Engineer

2016–2020

- Designed and developed production-grade digital products for healthcare, government, nonprofit, education, hospitality, and commercial organizations.
- Engineered responsive websites, custom web applications, CMS platforms, and digital marketing solutions with strong focus on performance, accessibility, SEO, and conversion.
- Integrated third-party APIs, CRM systems, payment gateways, and marketing-automation platforms to support client operations and business requirements.
- Built reusable frontend patterns and managed hosting, DNS, deployments, analytics, backups, security, and performance optimization across client environments.
- Partnered directly with designers, creative directors, account managers, and executives to deliver production-grade software under aggressive timelines.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

MOORE & SCARRY ADVERTISING (LATER CALDWELL & KERR / AFFINITIV)

Fort Myers, FL

Junior Graphic Designer → Senior Frontend Web Developer

2015–2016

- Progressed through four roles in 15 months, moving from design production into senior frontend development without a gap before joining Priority Marketing.
- Designed and built high-volume automotive dealership campaigns, responsive websites, landing pages, and digital advertising experiences using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP, WordPress, and Adobe tools.
- Owned frontend execution from design handoff through implementation and launch, applying visual hierarchy, typography, conversion strategy, and product thinking under aggressive deadlines.

INDEPENDENT / FREELANCE

Fort Myers, FL

Freelance Software Engineer

2010–2015

- Designed, developed, and deployed custom websites, CMS platforms, eCommerce solutions, and business applications for organizations across multiple industries.
- Built solutions using PHP, WordPress, Joomla, Drupal, osCommerce, ASP.NET MVC, C#, JavaScript, jQuery, HTML, CSS, and SQL Server.
- Managed the complete software lifecycle from discovery and architecture through development, deployment, optimization, and production support.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Front End: React, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, SCSS, Tailwind CSS, Stencil, Web Components, Redux, TanStack Start, Ionic, Storybook, Nx, Vite

Back End & Platform: Node.js, Bun, PHP, C#, ASP.NET MVC, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, SQL Server, Sequelize, Microsoft Entra ID, authentication and role-based authorization, Git, Azure DevOps, CI/CD

Design & Quality: Enterprise design systems, design tokens, Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, WCAG 2.1 AA, Section 508, accessibility, responsive design, performance, SEO, conversion optimization

LICENSES & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

FAA Private Pilot Certificate | FAA Instrument Rating – Airplane | Microsoft Azure professional coursework